



VIKRAM SHARMA

"He showed that it is possible to revitalise an institution in decline with a few well-chosen moves." A.K. Shivakumar, Consultant, UNICEF

Turning point

Quitting the IAS in 1975. "I was never cut out to be a civil servant."

Cut his administrative teeth

As city magistrate in Kanpur, Thana Seesganj, and later running the Common Entrance Test for IIMS when he was teaching at IIM Kolkata in 1980.

Passions Portrait photography, cinema (he founded Delhi University's film society, Celluloid) and bridge.

hostels, he's done it all.

With role models such as economists C.D. Deshmukh and K.N. Raj, institution builders both, it is no surprise he believes that change is possible not by fiat or by edict, but an ever-widening circle of stakeholders. Now professor of economics at Jawaharlal Nehru University, Nayyar, who spent his childhood in eight different mofussil schools, from a tent in Chandigarh to the Hindi-medium Adarsh Bal Vidyamandir in Hissar, firmly believes that institutions are larger than the individuals but individuals can, and do, make a difference. **by Kaveree Bamzai**



AMRIT SRINIVASAN | 60

PROFESSOR IN SOCIOLOGY, IIT Delhi

SOCIAL CONNECTION

Research and teaching is the academic's activism, a way to intervene in the world. This is what defines Amrit Srinivasan, whether it is by encouraging IIT's technical brains to look at a world beyond the sciences and engage with society or heading Paedia, a non-profit virtual archiving initiative to document the knowledge and practices of the people in India. "It's about giving students an education, not a technique," she says. That is why Srinivasan also has had engineering students who have gone on to do a Ph.D in sociology. There needs, she says, to be more activism in changing our curriculum that would enable students to take a mix of disciplines.

by Chitra Subramanyam